

The Direct Method (DM)

What is the Direct Method?

- ▶ The direct method which sometimes called the natural method is not limited to but often used in teaching foreign languages. The method refrains from using the learner's native language and uses only the target language.
- ▶ Its named 'direct' because meaning should be connected directly with the target language without translation into the native language.
- ▶ One basic rule → No Translation is allowed

History

- ▶ It was established in Germany and France around 1900, and it was an answer to the dissatisfaction with the older **Grammar Translation Method** which teaches students grammar and vocabulary through direct translations and thus focuses on the written language.
- ▶ One of its main proponents was the German Maximilian Berlitz, whose schools in the form of Berlitz international exists to this day.

Features of the Direct Method

- ▶ Teaching concepts and vocabulary through pantomime (exaggerating) meaning, real-life objects and other visual materials.
- ▶ Teaching grammar by using an inductive approach that is having learners find out rules through the presentation of adequate linguistic forms in the target language.
- ▶ Centrality of spoken language, including a native-like pronunciation.
- ▶ Focus on question-answer patterns.
- ▶ teacher-centred.

Principles of the Direct Method

- ▶ 1. Classroom instructions are conducted exclusively in the target language.
- ▶ 2. Only everyday vocabulary and sentences are taught during the initial phase. Grammar, reading and writing are introduced in the intermediate phase.
- ▶ 3. Oral communication skills are built up in a carefully graded progression organised around question-and-answer exchanges between teachers and students in small, intensive classes.
- ▶ 4. Grammar is taught inductively.
- ▶ 5. New teaching points are introduced orally.

Principles of the Direct Method

- ▶ 6. Complete vocabulary stored through demonstration, objects and pictures. Abstract vocabulary is taught by association of ideas.
- ▶ 7. Both speech and listening comprehensions are taught.
- ▶ 8. Correct pronunciation and grammar are emphasised.
- ▶ 9. Students should be speaking at least 89% of time during the lesson
- ▶ 10. Students are taught from inception to ask questions as well as answer them.

Teacher's Role	The role of the teacher is to direct class activities, encourage students to participate in class and corrects their mistakes immediately. But students and teachers are partners in the learning process.
Student's Role	Students are very active. Oral communication skills are emphasised, there is a large amount of learner - learner interaction.
Error Correction	The teacher, using various techniques, tries to get students to self- correct whenever possible.
Use of Mother Tongue	Students' native language shouldn't be used in the classroom.

Teaching Techniques in the Direct Method

- ▶ Reading aloud
- ▶ Question and answer exercise
- ▶ Getting students to self-correct
- ▶ Conversation practice
- ▶ Fill-in- the-blank exercise
- ▶ Dictation
- ▶ Map drawing (find west, east, mountain,)
- ▶ Paragraph writing



- ▶ Look at page 28-30

- ▶ Let's review the principles of the direct method

Activity

- ▶ In Grammar Translation Method (GTM), we learned that grammar was treated deductively. In the Direct Method, grammar is treated inductively. Can you explain the difference between deductive and inductive treatments of grammar?
- ▶ What are the distinctions between the GTM and the DM?

Comparison between the **GTM** and **DM**

GTM	DM
Maintains close association between the second language and the mother tongue	Avoids close association between the second language and the mother tongue
Lays emphasis on translation	Lays emphasis on speech
Follows the adult's natural way of learning a language	Follows the child's natural way of learning a language
Teaches the language by ' rule '	Teaches the language by ' use '
Teaches formal grammar from the beginning	Does not favour the teaching of formal grammar at the early stage

Criticism of the Direct Method

- ▶ The Direct Method was hard for public schools to integrate it. Constraints of budget, classroom size, time and teacher background (native speakers or nativelylike fluency) made such a method difficult to use.